

DONOVAN C. BROWN

AI Solutions Developer | Full-Stack Developer (React, Next.js) | Technical Instructor

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SUMMARY

Self-taught full-stack developer and technical instructor with 10 years across IT support, web and mobile development, and applied AI. I build accessible applications and integrate AI (retrieval-augmented assistants, chatbots, workflow automation) with production habits: error handling, evaluation, documentation. Organizer with AI Collective Detroit; instructor with JOURNi, Black Tech Saturdays. I help non-technical teams get good at the tools they are handed.

SKILLS

Applied AI: Prompt engineering, LLM API integration, retrieval-augmented generation (RAG), chatbots, AI evaluation

Languages and frameworks: JavaScript, TypeScript, React, React Native, Next.js, Angular, Node.js, HTML/CSS, REST APIs, Python

Automation and data: Microsoft Power Platform / Power Automate, Firebase, Supabase, workflow automation, Salesforce

Engineering practice: Accessibility, error handling, evaluation, documentation, privacy-safe data handling, Agile delivery

Teaching and enablement: Curriculum design, workshop facilitation, mentoring, technical communication

IT foundations: CompTIA A+, help desk and field service, Windows administration, systems support

SELECTED PROJECTS

Ask the Docs (RAG assistant), Personal project, in progress 2026

- Retrieval-augmented assistant that answers questions from a document set and cites its sources; built on public data with a documented evaluation approach.

Workflow Automation Demo, Personal project, in progress 2026

- Intake and ticket-triage flow built in Microsoft Power Platform on sample data, designed to be handed off to non-technical owners.

Small Business Social Media Strategy Planner (Custom GPT), Personal project 2026

- Built a custom GPT that turns a small business owner's product and seasonal info into a ready-to-post social media content calendar.

Hermes Agent — AI & Tech News Scouter, Personal project, 2026

- Runs an autonomous AI agent on a Raspberry Pi 5 that scouts and summarizes AI and tech news for content research and community updates.

Richland Food Pantry Website, Team project (7 members) 2024

- Rebuilt a single-page site into a multi-page site with information lookup, volunteer signup, social feed integration, and English/Spanish switching.

Storefront Chatbot, React, BotPress 2023

- Built a storefront demo with a conversational chatbot handling returns, deliveries, and warranty questions.

D12 Table Top, iOS app, React Native 2019

- Designed, built, and shipped to the App Store: dice rolling with modifiers and a persistent roll log.

EXPERIENCE

Technology Program Manager, Live6 Alliance, Detroit, MI 2025 to Present

- Manage a portfolio of small-business digital adaptation program across Livernois-Six mile corridor, coordinating with 15+ businesses.
- Develop a custom GPT and Google Gem AI to assist small businesses with social media marketing planning.

- Consulted with a small business to increase appointment bookings by 30% and boost product sales by 50%

Founder and Technical Mentor, Code Connect Mentoring, Harper Woods, MI 2024 to 2025

- Coach career-changers through resume, portfolio, and interview prep. *Mentored 7 + career-changers 4 landed developer roles within 6 months.*

UI Developer, CQL, Grand Rapids, MI (remote) 2022 to 2024

- Built and maintained user interfaces for digital commerce clients in React. *Delivered a custom CMS for an inventory system that reduces management time by 30%.*

Onsite Software Developer, Detroit Labs, Detroit, MI 2019 to 2022

- Built and maintained Rocket Mortgage/Quicken Loans, web properties (Rocket Homes, Rocket Careers, Rocket Loans, and others).

Manufacturing Systems Developer, Continental Structural Plastics, Arbor Hills 2018 - 2018

- Built and supported internal tooling by using production and quality teams to track manufacturing data, reducing manual reporting steps.

Web Developer / JavaScript Instructor (6 Month Contract), MRM//McCann, Birmingham, MI 2016 to 2017

- Supported the Analytics Team on GMC, Buick, and Chrysler websites, writing custom JavaScript and jQuery in Adobe Marketing Cloud to track analytics, manage web content, and add, remove, or hide page elements for client sites.
- Built and delivered internal training slides and mini-projects to instruct the Analytics Team on JavaScript and jQuery best practices, and attended client meetings on analytics tracking solutions.

Field Service Technician, Detroit Medical Center, Detroit, MI 2016 to 2016

- Supported clinical and administrative staff across hardware, software, and network issues in a hospital environment.

Help Desk Technician, Henry Ford OptiEyes (Henry Ford Health), Metro Detroit, MI 2011 to 2014

- Resolved hardware, software, and system issues for optical center staff across 21 locations; earned multiple internal employee recognitions for clear, patient support of non-technical colleagues.

Help Desk Analyst, Hewlett Packard, Pontiac, MI 2010 to 2011

- Provided first-line technical support and troubleshooting. Handled an average of 40+ inbound support tickets per week for enterprise hardware customers.

TEACHING, SPEAKING, AND COMMUNITY LEADERSHIP

- AI Collective Detroit: organizer and event host. Co-hosted "Learn to build AI Agents using Hermes" (One Detroit Center, Aug 2026) and a Claude Code for Developers session. Brokered partnerships with Hack The Nest (EMU) and NEI.
- JOURNi: lead instructor, adult workshops on Supabase and prompt engineering with LLMs (built curriculum and exercises); youth web development instructor. *Taught 5 workshop cohorts totaling roughly 60 adult learners.*
- Black Tech Saturdays: speaker, Digital Empowerment Summit 2025; Innovation and Growth Award, 2024.
- 100 Black Men of Greater Detroit: youth coding instructor at WCCCD. Guest speaker, Per Scholas Detroit. Volunteer instructor and community member with Grand Circus, Girl Develop It, Detroit Black Tech, and Developers of Detroit since 2017.
- Guest, Heart And Profit Podcast. Featured by nocsdegree.com. *YouTube: @AlandTechWithDonovan – Growing an audience of small business owners and solo entrepreneurs learning practical AI.*

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

- CompTIA A+ Certified
- Microsoft: Configuring and Administering Windows 7 (Course 50322)
- Full Stack Web Development, freeCodeCamp (2015); Grand Circus – 8 weeks Android development bootcamp Extensive (2014); Kaplan Career Institute (2009)
- In progress: Microsoft Azure AI Fundamentals (AI-901), then Azure AI Apps and Agents Developer Associate (AI-103)